

Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2023–24



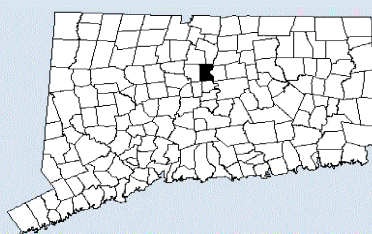
Achievement First Hartford Academy District

Laneka Thomas, Charter School Principal or Director • 860-695-5280 • <http://achievementfirst.org>

District Information

Grade Range	K-12
Number of Schools/Programs	1
Enrollment	961
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$15,747
Total Expenditures ¹	\$16,392,684

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2022-23 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2023-24 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2023 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	*	*	48.3
Male	485	50.5	51.5
Non-Binary	*	*	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	10	1.0	0.2
Asian	*	*	5.2
Black or African American	724	75.3	12.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	208	21.6	31.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	11	1.1	4.7
White	*	*	46.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	53	5.5	10.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	756	78.7	44.0
Students with Disabilities ³	108	11.2	17.9

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	125	28.2	13	2.7
Male	134	29.2	27	5.5
Non-Binary	0	*	0	*
Black or African American	164	23.8	29	4.0
Hispanic or Latino of any race	80	42.1	*	*
White	*	*	0	*
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	23	46.0	0	0.0
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	215	30.2	30	3.9
Students with Disabilities	41	38.3	*	*
District	259	28.7	40	4.1
State		17.7		7.0

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 314

Number of school-based arrests: 0

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

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Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	56.3
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	17.0
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	9.8
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	16.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	0.0
School Level	16.9
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	0.0
Support Staff	0.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	3.0
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	7.0
School Nurses	2.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	43.0

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	3	3.2	0.1
Asian	4	4.3	1.4
Black or African American	37	39.8	4.8
Hispanic or Latino of any race	9	9.7	5.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	1	1.1	0.3
White	39	41.9	88.3

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2022-23

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	6.1	13.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	50	100.0	49	100.0
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	*	16	*
White	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	37	100.0	43	100.0
Students with Disabilities	*	*	9	*
District	60	100.0	65	100.0
State		88.4		94.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students Who Spend 80% or Greater Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	N/A	N/A
Emotional Disability	N/A	N/A
Intellectual Disability	N/A	N/A
Learning Disability	N/A	N/A
Other Health Impairment	N/A	N/A
Other Disabilities	N/A	N/A
Speech/Language Impairment	N/A	N/A
District	N/A	N/A
State		66.8

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

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Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	N/A	N/A	2.6
Emotional Disability	N/A	N/A	1.1
Intellectual Disability	N/A	N/A	0.6
Learning Disability	N/A	N/A	6.4
Other Health Impairment	N/A	N/A	3.5
Other Disabilities	N/A	N/A	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	N/A	N/A	2.0
All Disabilities	N/A	N/A	17.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	N/A	N/A	8.0
Private Schools or Other Settings	N/A	N/A	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2022-23

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$9,187,385	\$8,826	\$12,942
Support services - students	\$1,736,667	\$1,668	\$1,724
Support services - instruction	\$632,196	\$607	\$905
Support services - general administration	.	.	\$520
Support services - school based administration	\$3,168,248	\$3,043	\$1,207
Central and other support services	\$1,557,975	\$1,497	\$771
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$105,956	\$102	\$2,101
Student transportation services	\$4,257	\$426	\$1,582
Food services	.	.	\$8
Enterprise operations	.	.	\$213
Total	\$16,392,684	\$15,747	\$21,143

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2022-23

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$1,610,348	61.9	27.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	.	.	10.2
Other Salaries	.	.	10.5
Employee Benefits	\$299,908	11.5	13.2
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$636,268	24.4	6.4
Special Education Tuition	.	.	22.2
Supplies	\$15,349	0.6	0.7
Property Services	.	.	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	.	.	8.4
Equipment	\$38,016	1.5	0.3
All Other Expenditures	\$3,041	0.1	0.1
Total	\$2,602,931	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		15.9	25.0

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2022-23

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	7.8
State	77.1
Federal	15.2
Tuition & Other	.

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

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Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	6	*	6	*	*	*
Asian	0	N/A	0	N/A	0	N/A
Black or African American	403	59.4	399	49.1	184	48.1
Hispanic or Latino of any race	105	56.3	103	47.1	41	45.4
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	N/A	0	N/A	0	N/A
Two or More Races	*	*	*	*	*	*
White	*	*	*	*	*	*
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	34	47.2	32	39.2	15	*
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	487	59.6	483	49.3	214	47.8
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	407	58.5	404	48.7	172	46.2
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	114	59.7	111	48.7	57	51.4
Students with Disabilities	46	37.8	46	30.9	18	*
Students without Disabilities	475	60.8	469	50.4	211	48.7
High Needs	422	58.1	418	48.5	178	46.2
Non-High Needs	99	61.7	97	49.7	51	52.3
District	521	58.8	515	48.7	229	47.5

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	80.2	79.1	79.0	87.5	301	81.4
Curl Up	86.9	69.7	79.2	68.1	299	76.6
Push Up	72.6	18.8	36.4	68.1	297	50.5
Mile Run/PACER	58.3	48.5	53.8	26.4	302	47.4
All Tests - District	43.2	12.5	28.9	18.1	293	26.6
All Tests - State	53.6	48.4	44.6	42.3		47.2

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

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Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2022-23	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	58	81.0
Hispanic or Latino of any race	13	*
White	N/A	N/A
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	58	81.0
Students with Disabilities	7	*
District	72	80.6
State		88.4

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2022-23 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Count	Rate (%)
Female	*	*
Male	*	*
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino	*	*
White	N/A	N/A
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	6	7.5
Students with Disabilities	0	*
District	15	12.0
State		44.3

³Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

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IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2023	Class of 2022
	Entrance ⁵ Rate (%)	Persistence ⁶ Rate (%)
Female	67.6	71.0
Male	73.9	45.0
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	70.8	67.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	*
White	N/A	N/A
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	71.4	*
Students with Disabilities	*	*
District	70.0	60.8
State	68.4	87.2

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

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Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	58.8	75	39.2	50	78.3	63.9
	High Needs Students	58.1	75	38.7	50	77.4	54.1
Math Performance Index	All Students	48.7	75	32.5	50	64.9	60.2
	High Needs Students	48.5	75	32.3	50	64.6	49.5
Science Performance Index	All Students	47.5	75	31.7	50	63.4	61.8
	High Needs Students	46.2	75	30.8	50	61.6	51.4
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	58.8%	100%	58.8	100	58.8	58.7%
	High Needs Students	58.7%	100%	58.7	100	58.7	54.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	51.2%	100%	51.2	100	51.2	61.4%
	High Needs Students	52.0%	100%	52.0	100	52.0	55.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	39.3%	100%	19.7	50	39.3	58.9%
	Oral	49.8%	100%	24.9	50	49.8	55.2%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	28.7%	<=5%	2.7	50	5.4	17.7%
	High Needs Students	29.9%	<=5%	0.2	50	0.4	25.5%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	100.0%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	91.5%
	% Meeting Benchmark	12.0%	75%	8.0	50	16.0	44.3%
On-track to High School Graduation		85.3%	94%	45.4	50	90.8	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2023 Cohort)		80.6%	94%	85.7	100	85.7	88.4%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2021 Cohort)		100.0%	94%	100.0	100	100.0	86.6%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2023)		70.0%	75%	93.3	100	93.3	68.4%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		98.3% 26.6%	75%	17.7	50	35.5	93.6% 47.2%
Arts Access		46.2%	60%	38.5	50	77.1	55.0%
Accountability Index				912.0	1450	62.9	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					N
ELA Performance Index Gap	61.7	58.1	3.7	16.9	
Math Performance Index Gap	49.7	48.5	1.2	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	52.3	46.2	6.1	17.9	
Graduation Rate Gap	.	100.0%	.	9.9%	N

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	99.2
	High Needs Students	99.1
Math	All Students	98.5
	High Needs Students	98.1
Science	All Students	99.1
	High Needs Students	98.9

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: * **State: 49.7**

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

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Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

Hartford Academy is a part of the Achievement First (AF) network of schools, and as such, benefits from the latest research, training, and support in providing differentiated instruction to students with special needs or requiring additional support. Team Special Services works closely with our school's special services leaders to design programs and interventions tailored to our school population. AF's curriculum team works with our special education team around differentiating best practices to serve all scholars. During the special education cohort meetings, special education leaders also share resources and collaborate on ways to make the curriculum more accessible.

We ground ourselves in our Special Services Playbook, a manual for school leaders, special services leaders, and teachers in identifying and addressing student needs. It provides tools for building an inclusive environment, ensuring that all scholars achieve academically and behaviorally at high levels. Co-teaching is a primary strategy utilized at Hartford Academy to reach inclusiveness and a least restrictive environment. This approach allows teachers to collect more data, provide more feedback, and offer more targeted support in leading students to the same rigorous academic and behavioral outcomes. Hartford Academy works with the New Haven district for the IEP process and uses the CT SEDS system. The Hartford team meets with the New Haven district team each month to collaborate on upcoming IEP meetings. At Hartford Academy, families have a space to share and actively participate in their child's IEP meeting. Additionally, special education teachers engage with families during school events, progress report nights, and send weekly communication.

Maintaining high daily attendance and low chronic absenteeism rates are our high priorities. This work has become even more critical after COVID, as students were still missing school due to COVID illnesses and other pandemic-related reasons. Our principals set the vision for school attendance and student culture. Families are informed on our daily attendance goals and partner with us in getting their child to school every day. Our social workers help reduce attendance barriers by providing additional support as needed. School staff reach out to families to determine the reason for a student's absence, which is critical in unearthing the root causes. The attendance committee meets regularly to review attendance data, identify additional supports that students may need, and find ways to celebrate/incentivize strong attendance habits. Hartford Academy continues to focus on ensuring student safety and maintaining family engagement as core components of student attendance. Families receive frequent communication from teachers and school staff to engage in learning activities. Report card nights continue to be well attended. Hartford Academy makes efforts to involve families in the planning and leadership of school events. Teachers are accessible to parents in various forms of communication (email, phone, or text). School staff also utilize ParentSquare to communicate with families, ensuring that all families have access to the content. Senior Community outreach and student recruitment is led by a dedicated Senior Community Outreach Associate who coordinates efforts and explores partnerships with the community our school serves.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

Hartford Academy's mission is to prepare every student to excel in college and career, deepen their knowledge of self and community, and lead lives of purpose. In partnership with our families and communities, we work to disrupt the legacy of inequity in education. We believe fulfilling this mission and reducing achievement gaps based on race and economic status, will reduce the isolation for our scholars. We aim for our schools to reflect the demographic composition of the neighborhoods we serve, and prepare our scholars to achieve academic success, and career and college readiness. The schools partner with the Achievement First's recruitment team to execute a comprehensive recruitment strategy consisting of direct outreach, Refer A Friend campaigns, information sessions, school-based open houses, presentations at local education agencies and community based organizations, neighborhood canvassing at nearby high-density housing and building locations, and geo-targeted mailings to reach families across the region. Our recruitment team leverages partnerships with local universities and organizations that support educators from diverse backgrounds. Notable partnerships include The National Fellowship for Black and Latino Male Educators and Profound Gentlemen, which help us intentionally diversify and support our candidate pool. We have designed and implemented training for all hiring managers to ensure our interview practices mitigate implicit bias, allowing all prospective staff to have an equitable interview process. Additionally, we advertise our career openings across diverse areas and websites to build brand awareness and attract candidates of all demographics and backgrounds. Preparation for the college experience begins in 9th grade with the Foundations of Leadership course, a 4-year program designed to help scholars navigate the more complex high school and post-secondary school world, with an emphasis on overcoming obstacles through effort. Each year culminates in scholars completing high stakes applications, preparing them for the college application process. High school scholars apply to and attend a variety of summer programs to prepare for the college experience and the diverse populations they will encounter when moving onto college.

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Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

Hartford Academy charter school district comprises 3 individual campuses. Decisions around resource allocation align with the district's strategic plan priorities and goals. Each school has a Director of Operations(DSO) who is responsible for non-instructional activities, including budgeting and resource acquisition. DSOs from each school across the Achievement First (AF) network meet regularly to standardize processes, procedures, and activities. The Hartford Board of Directors reviews and approves the annual budget and the financial reports at each of their meetings, including school-level detail with key comparable metrics. Financial reporting is centralized; AF's Chief Financial Officer ensures resources are allocated comparably throughout the network. Hartford Academy regularly reviews data and adjusts the resource allocation process to remain responsive to evolving student needs and maintain equity. This review may include input from school administrators, teachers, parents, and community stakeholders. Adjustments may be made based on changes in student demographics, academic performance, or other relevant factors to address the school's needs in line with the strategic plan.